CHAPTER-IV

ARTHĀPATTI IN ADVAITA VEDĀNTA SCHOOL

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4.1 *Vedānta-Paribhāṣā* as *Pramāṇa Śāstra*:

Bādrāyaṇa is the founder of Vedānta Philosophy, and he writes *Brahmasūtra*. Different commentaries are based on *Brahmasūtra,* and one commentary is written by Śaṁkara, which is known as *Śārīrakabhāṣya*. Śaṁkar is the systematic expounder of the Advaita Vedānta school. Though the language of Śaṁkara's commentary is simple, the subject is too hard. There are three roots of the entire Advaita Vedānta (*prasthāna*) for explaining the Śaṁkara's commentary, viz. *Vivaraṇa-Prasthāna*, *Bhāmatī-Prasthāna* and *Śārīraka-Prasthāna*. All of them agreed on the significance of the *Vedic* sentences, though they are different in view about the practical aspect of the object of cognition. But, no *prasthāna* dealt with the concept of an instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*) and object of valid cognition (*prameya*) clearly. Keeping this problem in view, Dharmarājā Adhvarīndra writes the book *Vedānta-Paribhāṣā*.[120] In this book, he deals with the instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*) and the object of valid cognition (*prameya*) in details. So, we depend on the book *Vedānta-Paribhāṣā* to know clearly the view of Advaita Vedānta regarding epistemology. Though, in this book, Dharmarājā Adhvarīndra relates this epistemological view with the metaphysical view of Advaita Vedānta. Also, Śaṁkara as we found in the *Vedānta-Paribhāṣā*, accepts six sorts of instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*) like the Bhāṭṭa school, viz. perception (*pratyakṣa*), inference (*anumāna*), comparison (*upamāna*), testimony (*śabda*), presumption (*arthāpatti*), and non-apprehension (*anupalabdhi*).

Now, in this chapter, we will discuss the nature of *arthāpatti* (presumption) according to the Advaita Vedānta school, the classification of *arthāpatti* and why they have admitted *arthāpatti* (presumption) as an independent instrument of valid

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[120] *Vedānta-Paribhāṣā*, p. Introduction (3).

cognition (*pramāṇa*). A discussion about the difference in the view between Advaita Vedānta and Bhāṭṭa schools will also be placed at the end of this chapter.

4.2 Relevance of *Arthāpatti*:

Advaita Vedānta accepts *arthāpatti* (presumption) as an independent instrument of valid cognition to explain the *Vedāntic* texts. It has also been stated that Śaṁkara's Advaita Vedānta school dealt with exploring the *Brahma-sūtra* for applying its scriptural view to familiar people like us. That is why Śaṁkara and his disciples always try to understand the intelligible capability of the persons participating in the dialogue. Furthermore, the Advaita Vedānta school applies *arthāpatti* (presumption) to the contexts where an apparent inconsistency is found in the *Vedāntic* texts. They are opined that *arthāpatti* (presumption) is also a crucial instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*) to represent the proper meaning of *Vedāntic* texts and capable of removing apparent inconsistencies related to Vedānta Philosophy. For example, the *Taiteriya Upaniṣad* describes the creation of this world with the help of *Brahman*[121] and, again, *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* says that *Brahman* is alone real[122]. This inconsistency is resolved by assuming that the creation of this world is not real but apparent (*vivarta*) as the shell appears as silver. Here, Advaita Vedāntins assume the existence of *māyā* as the power of *Brahman* for resolving such conflict, and such type of assumption is called *arthāpatti* (presumption) – "*idānīmarthāpattinirūpyate*".[123]

Also, there is a lengthy discussion among the followers of the Advaita Veādnta regarding *arthāpatti* (presumption) to know *ajñāna*. However, different authors have tried to explain *ajñāna* through *anumāna*, *śruti* like *arthāpatti*. One may ask: why are these three sorts of instruments of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*) accepted

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[121] "*tasmādvā etasmādātmana ākāśaḥ smbhūtaḥ*." *Taiteriya Upaniṣad*, 2/1.

[122] "*eko devaḥ sarbabhūteṣu gūḍhaḥ sarbavyāpī sarbabhūtāntarātmā, karmādhyakṣaḥ sarbabhūtādhivāsaḥ sākṣī cetā kevalo nirguṇaśca*." *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad*, 6/11.

[123] *Vedānta-Paribhāṣā*, p. 214.

together to know the same reality? In response to this question, it is important to mention that Advaita Vedāntins have accepted an instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*) as per the demands of the context. They have accepted different sorts of instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*) as there are different contexts. In cases where the application of *anumāna* is not possible due to a lack of *vyāpti* (invariable concomitance), *arthāpatti* (presumption) plays a vital role to reconcile the apparent inconsistency of the subject matter. In the case mentioned above, it is seen that establishment of *vyāpti* (invariable concomitance) is not possible between the truth of the *Brahman* and the falsity of this created world. That is why Advaita Vedāntins take the help of *arthāpatti* (presumption) to reconcile the above-mentioned apparent inconsistency.

Bādrāyaṇa has mentioned in the very first verse of his *Brahma-Sūtra* that "*athāto Brahmanjiñāsā*", i.e., it is a duty to get involved for knowing the *Brahman* after the study of the *Veda*-s. *Brahman* is the only one cognizable of the saviors. However, the *Upaniṣad*-s say that self-cognition (*ātma jñāna*) is the cause of liberation (*mukti*).[124] Now, the question comes: if self-cognition (*ātma jñāna*) is the only way to lead to liberation (*mukti*), why does one desire to know the *Brahman*? To respond to this question Advaita Vedāntins say that in the liberated state the *Brahman* is cognized as Self and the *Brahman* is identical with the Self. This truth has been told in different *Upaniṣad*-s, viz., "*ayamātmā Brahman*"[125], "*tattvamasi*"[126], "*ahaṁ Brahmāsmi*"[127]. However, in this mundane world, we have cognized as '*manuṣyo'ham*', '*Brāhmaṇo'ham*', etc. Again, the question is: how can one feel that we are identical with the *Brahman*? In response, Advaitins said that actually, this is the main problem in our mundane existence. Because such self-conceit feelings are even produced due to our ignorance, we cannot identify ourselves with *Brahman* due to such ignorance. So, one should realize this worldly creation is false. If we realize

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[124] "*ātmā vā're draṣṭabyaḥ śrotavyo mantabyo nididhyāsitabyaḥ*". *Bṛhadārnyak Upaniṣad*: 4-5-6,

[125] *Māṇḍukya Upaniṣad*: 2.

[126] *Chandogya Upaniṣad*: 6-8-7.

[127] *Bṛhadārṇyak Upaniṣad*: 1-4-10.

that this worldly creation is false, we should realize that the *Brahman* is the only Real and identify us with the *Brahman*. Therefore, the realization of this world as false, and after that, our self-cognition (*ātma jñāna*) is possible. *Brahman* is only real, and such cognition is possible after self-cognition (*ātma jñāna*). Knowing such truth, one should engage in realizing the *Brahman* and after the appropriate cognition of *Brahman*, felt *Brahman* is only real and identify with *Brahman*. Now, it is essential to establish that the *ajñāna* has existed in this world and that truth can be known only by an instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*). If *ajñāna* can be known through *pramāṇa*, then such a type of *ajñāna* can be established. Therefore, the necessity of a suitable *pramāṇa* is needed first of all. Advaita Vedāntins claim that *arthāpatti* (presumption) plays a vital role to know *ajñāna*.

4.3 Nature of *Arthāpatti*:

Dharmarājā Adhvarīndra defines *arthāpatti* (presumption) as the assumption of an explanatory fact (*upapādaka*) from a cognition of the thing to be explained (*upapādya*) – "*tatropapādya-jñānenopapādaka-kalpanamarthāpatti*".[128] Here, the cognition of the seen facts is the instrument, and the cognition of the unseen or assumed fact is the result. *Upapādya* is one which cannot be explained without assuming another fact. The fact which is assumed to explain *upapādya* is known as *upapādaka*[129]. We may illustrate this with the help of an example. The stoutness of a man who does not eat during day time (*pīno Devadatta divā na bhūñkte*) is inexplicable without the assumption of his eating at night. One who does not eat both day and night cannot be stout. Here, the stoutness of such a man in the absence of eating in the day time is called *upapādya*, and the assumption of eating at night is called *upapādaka*. So, the assumption of an explanatory fact from an unexplained fact is called *arthāpatti* (presumption).

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[128] Ibid., p. 214.

[129] "*jena vinā jadanupapannam tat tatropapādyam. Yasyāvāve yasyānupapattistat tatropapādakam*." Ibid., p. 214.

4.4 Classification of *Arthāpatti*:

Dharmarājā Adhvarīndra mentions two sorts of *arthāpatti* (presumption) like Kumārila Bhaṭṭa, viz. *dṛṣṭārthāpatti* (presumption from the seen) and *śrutārthāpatti* (presumption from the heard). *Arthāpatti,* which is based on an instrument of valid cognition other than testimony, is called *dṛṣṭārthāpatti*. Suppose, one wrongly perceives that 'this is silver' (*idaṁ rajataṁ*) in a place and subsequently he again perceives that 'this is not silver' (*nedaṁ rajataṁ*). The second perception denies the first one. If the silver is taken as real, then the fact of denial cannot be explained. From this, one can assume that the early cognition of silver is false. This type of *arthāpatti* (presumption) is the example of *dṛṣṭārthāpatti*.

The *arthāpatti* for resolving the conflict of any sentence which is heard is called *śrutārthāpatti*, e.g., the scriptural statement '*tarati śokamātmavaditi*'[130] (the knower of self transcends grief), i.e., cognition is the cause of making one free from bondage. However, the question arises: if the bondage is the real one, then how can one be free from bondage through the help of cognition? To avoid such conflict, the hearer assumes that bondage is not real, but illusory; and such type of assumption is not possible without the help of *arthāpatti* (presumption), i.e., *śrutārthāpatti*.

Śrutārthāpatti again has been sub-divided into *abhidhānānupapatti* (inconsistency due to the failure of expression) and *abhihitānupapatti* (inconsistency due to the incongruity of the meaning). The *arthāpatti* (presumption) called *abhidhānānupapatti* is taken place when a part of a sentence is expressed, and there is a failure of consistency of expression and syntactical relation. In order to complete the syntactical relation, some additional word is postulated, i.e., *abhidhānānupapatti*. Say for example, if any speaker utters only the word '*dvāraṁ*' (door), and then from this, the syntactical relation cannot be understood by the hearer. In that case, the hearer assumes the word '*pidhehi*' (close), and thereby, he understands that the very intention of the speaker is to utter the entire sentence in the form '*dvāraṁ pidhehi*' (close the door). Here, the inconsistency that occurred due to listening to the word '*dvāraṁ*' (door) is resolved through the assumption of the word '*pidhehi*' (close).

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[130] *Chāndogya Upaniṣad*: VII, i.3.

We come across a sentence in the *Veda*-s as 'he should perform the sacrifice called *viśvajit*' (*viśvajitā yajeta*). However, this sentence gives birth to a problem about who is to perform the sacrifice. This problem can be resolved only by assuming the sentence that the person who is interested in attaining heaven (*svargakāmaḥ*) should perform the sacrifice called '*viśvajit*'. In the case of the second kind of *śrutārthāpatti,* i.e., *abhihitānupapatti*, a fact is presumed to resolve the inconsistency of the meaning of a sentence, for example, we can find a sentence in the *Veda*-s as 'one who desires heaven should perform the *jyotiṣṭoma* sacrifice' (*svargakāmo jyotiṣṭomena yajeta*). This sentence is well syntaxed, and its meaning is also clear. However, here the problem is that from this sentence, we know if someone performed the sacrifice called *jyotiśṭoma*, then he must attain heaven. We also understand what is said in the *Veda*-s can never be false. But, through the performing of the sacrifice, one could not attain heaven instantly. Also, we know that the effect is produced from the cause immediately. Therefore, in order to resolve the inconsistency of the meaning of this sentence '*svargakāmo jyotiṣṭomena yajeta*', a potency called '*apūrva*' is presumed, which is produced by the performance and abides in the performer's soul till the heaven is attained. Performance of sacrifice is a momentary event, but heaven is attained after death. So, there is a long gap between the cause (performance of the sacrifice) and the effect (attainment of heaven). Here, an attempt has been made to bridge the gap just by assuming the potency called '*apūrva*', and thereby, the inconsistency of the meaning of the sentence is resolved. Therefore, *arthāpatti* (presumption) plays a vital role to fill up the gap.

4.5 Distinction between Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṁsā's view and Advaita Vedānta's view on *Arthāpatti*:

Arthāpatti (presumption) has been admitted by both the Bhāṭṭas and the Advaita Vedāntins. However, if we closely scrutinize, then we will see the difference between their view. Both of the schools are of the opinion that it is the inexplicability that leads to taking the shelter of the instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*) called *arthāpatti* (presumption). But, one group of thinkers differs from the other group of thinkers on another issue. It is stated that inexplicability is the cause that leads to

taking the help of *arthāpatti* (presumption). However, the question is, what is the reason for this inexplicability? In reply to this question, the Bhāṭṭa philosophers hold that apparent contradiction is the cause of the inexplicability in question; but, Dharmarājā Adhvarīndra does not specify any reason for it. But it is important to note that though Dharmarājā Adhvarīndra did not clearly mention the cause of inexplicability like the Bhāṭṭas, moreover, if we have a close look, then it can be seen that there is an element of contradiction in most of the examples of *arthāpatti* (presumption) offered by him. The exceptional case which we come across is the example of the first kind of *śrutārthāpatti* (*abhidhānānupapatti*) given by Dharmarājā Adhvarīndra.

In the example of the first kind of *śrutārthāpatti*, we cannot find any contradiction though there is inexplicability. Let me explain the example. In that example, only the word '*dvāraṁ*' (door) is uttered by the speaker, and later on, the hearer tries to resolve the inconsistency just by adding the word '*pidhehi*' (close) with the word '*dvāraṁ*' (door), which the speaker utters. Both Dharmarājā Adhvarīndra and the Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṁsakas opine that the addition of a word in order to complete a sentence is one of the necessary conditions of an instance of *śrutārthāpatti*. In the example, as mentioned earlier, there is no contradiction at all. A contradiction arose when we saw conflict with our general experience gathered in the past. More clearly, contradiction takes birth when what is seen to happen instead of what we expect to happen best in our past experience. This is not true in the case of this example in question. When someone is seen to utter the word '*dvāraṁ*', there is, in fact, nothing that is opposed to our past experience. What the sentence actually does is nothing but create the expectation in the mind of the hearer. The hearer in the first moment listens to the word '*dvāraṁ*' uttered by the speaker, and in the subsequent moment, an expectation of hearing a more words from the speaker's mouth arises in the hearer's mind. Here, contradiction might have occurred if the hearer would be expected to listen to one additional word from the speaker's mouth, which is appropriate in the context concerned. Still, the speaker would utter a different word. If the speaker, for example, would say '*dvāraṁ pidhehi*' (close the door), when the weather outside the room is too hot, then that sentence would cause a conflict with the expectation of the hearer in that situation. Apparently, we may think that here also a contradiction arises

because the utterance of the word '*dvāraṁ*' also gives rise to conflict as far as the hearer does not know for the time being whether he should close the door or see the design or colour of it. However, if we carefully analyzed the case, it can be understood that it is not a genuine case of contradiction. Here, the conflict is not between cognition or fact as it occurs between two subjective responses of the hearer invoked by the word '*dvāraṁ*', where the word itself is not one of the conflicting parties. Here, the inexplicability in question is not due to its incompatibility with our experience, and instead, it is produced due to the failure of the speaker to express his full intention. In this case, the hearer takes the help of *arthāpatti* (presumption) of the word '*pidhehi*', not only based on hearing the word '*dvāraṁ*', but also on the basis of context. Therefore, the Advaitins have so much emphasized on the context instead of conflict, whereas Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṁsakas have emphasized on the conflict between the two. It may be the point that Advaitins are so much aware of context rather than conflict because they have taken varieties of examples for explaining the nature of *arthāpatti* (presumption) and also different sorts of inexplicability to the examples. That is why context plays a vital role in *arthāpatti* (presumption).

4.6 Observation:

From the previous discussion, the question comes: which view between the Advaita and the Bhāṭṭa is more acceptable? There are the *Vedic* statements in which we are coming across apparently seems having inconsistency, some statements involve contradiction, and all these problems can be eradicated through the application of the *arthāpatti*. The question of more acceptability doesn't come in. Because the question of more acceptability comes only when the ground is one and the same. But the grounds along with the metaphysical presuppositions are actually different in the mentioned philosophical schools. So, the question of more acceptability or superiority or inferiority is superfluous. But, the common factor for accepting *arthāpatti* as a distinct *pramāṇa* is its purpose. Because the main purpose of both of the schools is the application of the *arthāpatti,* to understand the importance of the basic statements just by eradicating the apparent inconsistency.

As long as this contradiction cannot be eradicated through the application of *arthāpatti*, we cannot understand the proper meaning of these *Vedic* statements. Because we know that whatever is said in the *Veda*-s is must be true. But if the *Vedic* statements are true, then the statement regarding the attainment of the *mokṣa* stated in the *Veda*-s must be true. Hence, it follows that the attainment of *mokṣa* of *jīva*-s is a factual statement. But the attainment of *mokṣa* cannot be possible unless and until the bondage is taken to be false. So, here actually, the application of *arthāpatti* gives us the initial step to resolve this contradiction, inexplicability, and thereby the way for understanding the reality of the *Vedic* statements.

If we have a closed look, then it has been understood that all the *pramāṇa*-s actually help us to know the ultimate cognition of the *Brahman*. The cognition of the *Brahman* implies necessarily pre-suppositions of some other cognitions. If we are to reach the state of the cognition of the *pāramārthika* state, then we have to realize the state of the *pāramārthika*, then there is one and only one ultimate reality that is the *Brahman*. It implies again the world which cannot be true. But the question is, if we come to know that the *Brahman* is the one and only one ultimate reality, then how can we come to know that the so-called perceived world is actually false? Because we, the common people, perceive the world and accept it to be true and it cannot be denied. So, there is a problem. Our *śāstra* is saying that the *Brahman* is the only ultimate truth. But our perceptual cognition says that this world is very much true. So, there is some sort of inconsistency between what is stated in the *Veda* and what is known by us through our common perceptual cognition in our day-to-day life. So, it comes that we have not reached the stage of ultimate cognition, then we have to overcome this inconsistency. Again, the question comes: how can this inconsistency be overcome? Here again, it is the *arthāpatti*, i.e., *śrutārthāpatti* that helps us to overcome this inconsistency. Because, through the application of *śrutārthāpatti*, we are actually proving that what is said by the *Veda* cannot be false; in other words, what is said in the *Veda* must be true. The *Veda* says that the *Brahman* is the only truth. If this is the case, then the world cannot be true. That means our perceptual cognition about the validity of this world cannot be accepted as true. Had it been accepted to be true? It directly contradicts what is said by the *Veda*. So, the *Vedic* statements cannot be true in that case. However, what is said in the *Veda* cannot be false. Therefore, the

inconsistency has been raised. That is why the necessity of *śrutārthāpatti* is needed to reconcile the apparent inconsistency.

We have to keep in our mind that the *Vedic* statement is given priority, and no question can be raised regarding the authority of the *Veda*-s. The *Veda*-s must be granted to be true. However, the question is that in the initial stage, we come across so many contradictions in understanding what is said by the *Veda,* and unless and until this contradiction is eradicated, we cannot actually realize what is said by the *Veda* to be true and that is in any cost at the primary level we have to eradicate this contradiction or inconsistency. This inconsistency can be removed through the application of *arthāpatti*. So, the observation is that here the application of the *arthāpatti* helps us to attain the cognition of the *Brahman* as a true, and this mundane world is false. But we have to keep in mind that though all of the *pramāṇa*-s help us to attain the stage of *mokṣa* but all of them are not of the same nature. Some of them are primary, and some of them are secondary. In this way, *arthāpatti* is obviously one of the secondary *pramāṇa* to the attainment of the cognition of the *Brahman,* and thereby it helps us to attain the stage of the *mokṣa*.

It is also observed that same is the viewed of the Mīmāṁsā school also. The ultimate, according to the Mīmāṁsā school, is the attainment of heaven (*svarga*). Now the question is, how can heaven be attained? Heaven can be attained, according to the Mīmāṁsā school, only through the performance of the *yajña* because they believe in the theory of *karma*. According to them, the ultimate goal is the attainment of heaven only through the performance of the *yajña* as the *Veda*-s prescribe it. But here again, some sorts of problems come in our day-to-day life. Suppose we know that the *Veda* says that if someone performs the *viśvajit yajña*, then he should attain the state of heaven. So, this is the statement of the *Veda,* and whatever is said by the *Veda* cannot be false; it must be true. If Mr. X performs the *viśvajit yajña* as per the prescription of the *Veda*-s, he must be successful and in attain heaven. But so far as our day-to-day life is a concern, we say that types of people actually perform the *viśvajit yajña* in this way. He cannot attain the *mokṣa* immediately because we know there is a close connection between cause and effect. So, whenever we see that the cause is performed, there should have been an immediate effect. We have the cause of the *viśvajit yajña*, and the effect of the same is the attainment of heaven. Here the

cause is performed by somebody else, then there should have been the attainment of the *mokṣa* immediately. But this is not seen. That is why there is some sort of inconsistency arises in our life. That type of inconsistency can be eradicated and has to be cape aside. How can it be done? That can be done through the help of the *arthāpatti*. Through *arthāpatti*, it is known that whatever is said by the *Veda* cannot be false. Here *arthāpatti* helps us to eradicate this inconsistency and says that the performer of the *viśvajit yajña* must attain heaven, but it is not done immediately. That can be possible through the imagination of the power of *apūrva*. Just by assuming the power of the *apūrva* through the application of the *arthāpatti*, the inconsistency that was coming on the way of understanding what is said by the *Veda*. In this way, such type of problem can be eradicated just through the conception to the application of the *arthāpatti*.

In this way, we can see that in both of the cases, the case of the Mīmāṁsā philosophy and the case of the Advaita philosophy, here actually both of them are of the opinion that interpretation of the *Vedic* statements is very much important. Whatever is said in the *Veda*-s cannot be false. Both of them have given prime importance to the *Veda*-s. Actually, we try to understand the truth of the *Veda* in our day-to-day life. We actually come across some inconsistencies, and those inconsistencies can be resolved only through the application of the *arthāpatti*.